Empirical research design and methods in Accounting

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The purpose of this course is to introduce students to empirical research design, particularly causal inference, and good methods to enable a reproducible pipeline. To that end, students are required to use git for version control. Students will complete empirical exercises replicating Ian Gow and Martien Lubberink's Empirical Research in Accounting: Tools and Methods (Python Polars edition) alongside custom problem sets I have designed for this course.

Session 1 (18 November 2026) Introduction to Python and Causal inference

Pre-class work

1. Set up an account on Git if you don't already have it, and install git (see instructions at https://github.com/git-guides/install-git).
2. Create a folder on your computer, which we will henceforth refer to as the *course workspace*. Open a terminal in this folder (in Windows go to the folder in file manager, right click and then click more and in the expanded list click "open git bash here". Now follow the steps given in the Git repository instructions document.
3.